While Tony and Rhodey are busy escaping from the mansion, "Iron Patriot" boards Air Force One, supposedly to guard the president of the United States. But no one aboard realizes that under his helmet, this Iron Patriot is not James Rhodes.

The plane is based closely on the real Air Force One, but "we reconfigured it," Bill Brzeski says. "We upgraded a few things. The real plane's much bigger than ours. What we did was: You got on to the plane, and the office and the conference room were pretty much exactly like Air Force One. People know that plane; you can't make it up.

"But when you go in where the people sit, in the back, we just made that a little bit smaller and put a wall across there. We did not show the upstairs of the plane where the communications centers are. All that wasn't necessary for the storytelling, because basically what happens is the plane blows up rather quickly and the people get sucked out."